

# Michael Litainas

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## SUMMARY

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An applied macroeconomist with a PhD in Economics and experience across Government, Central Banking, Academia and Policy Institutions. My research focuses on international economics, fiscal and monetary policy, and energy shocks, and I have a solid background in time-series and panel-data econometrics, and general equilibrium models. Fluent in R, Matlab and Python.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Department of Business and Trade, UK Government

Feb 2025 - today

#### Macroeconomic Modelling Unit - Economic Modeller

- Carrying out targeted research to inform policy decisions on evolving economic issues.
- Leading the development of a multi-sector structural model for the UK economy.
- Maintaining and further developing the large scale **semi-structural model**, used for producing the long-term forecasts accompanying the Global Trade Outlook publication of the UK government. Code in Python.
- Conducting ex-ante impact assessment of Free Trade Agreements and Geopolitical events using Computable General Equilibrium models.
- Regularly communicating analysis findings to senior policy makers and other internal and external clients.
- **Tools:** DSGE, SVAR, CGE (GTAP), Semi-structural modelling - Python, R, Matlab.

### The Bank of England - PhD Researcher

Jul 2024 - Dec 2024

#### Prudential Policies - Insurance Policy Division

- Led a research project on the effects of Quantitative Easing on UK and US corporate bond defaults.
- Drafted a working paper providing evidence that inform prudential policy in the insurance sector.
- Conducted analysis using state-of-the-art time-series SVAR models.
- **Tools:** SVAR, Matlab, R

### University of Sheffield - Graduate Teaching Assistant

Oct 2021 - Jun 2024

#### Department of Economics

Taught the following courses and computer labs:

- Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG), Mathematical Methods for Economics (UG)
- Stata labs - Econometric Methods (PG), Applied Macroeconometrics (PG)

### CEDEFOP - Traineeship

Sep 2018 - Jul 2019

#### The European Centre for the Development of Vocational Training

#### Department of Skills and Labour Markets

- Contributed to the European Skills Index and Skills Forecasts projects.
- Assisted in the drafting of reports in topics related to Skills and Labour markets.
- Reviewed in-house survey methodologies and data collection practices.
- Exploratory analysis of micro-data with R.

## EDUCATION

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|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>PhD in Economics</b><br>University of Sheffield, UK     | <b>2020 - 2024</b> |
| <b>MSc in Economics</b><br>University of Macedonia, Greece | <b>2017 - 2019</b> |
| <b>BSc in Economics</b><br>University of Macedonia, Greece | <b>2012 - 2017</b> |

## RESEARCH

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### Publications

- “News and Surprises: Revisiting Fiscal Shocks in the Open Economy”, with P. McAdam, A. Montagnoli and K. Mouratidis. *Journal of International Money and Finance* ([link](#))

### Work in Progress

- “When UK Government spends, which sectors gain most? Decomposing the UK government spending multiplier” (**Job Market Paper, work in progress**)
- “The effects of Large-Scale Asset Purchases programmes on US and UK corporate bond defaults” (**BoE working paper - to be published soon**)

## SKILLS

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### Econometrics:

- Advanced skills in the following time-series models used in forecasting and structural analysis: VAR, SVAR, GVAR, Factor models. Solid knowledge of macroeconomic shock identification methods.
- Advanced skills of panel data and spatial panel data methods.
- Advanced knowledge of DSGE models.

### Programming and Languages:

- Advanced Knowledge: R, Matlab, Dynare, Eviews, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, MS Office
- Intermediate Knowledge: Python, Julia, Stata, Git
- Basic Knowledge: SQL, HTML
- English (*Proficient*), Greek (*Native*), French (*Beginner*), German (*Beginner*)

## PRIZES AND SCHOLARSHIPS

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- Nominated for the University of Sheffield Education Awards (*GTA*), 2023 - 2024
- Departmental research studentship, University of Sheffield, 2020 - 2023
- Best 1st year student presentation prize, PhD conference University of Sheffield, 2021
- Scholarship awarded based on academic excellence, MSc in Economics, University of Macedonia, 2018
- Greek Institute of State Scholarships (IKY) - Second highest GPA among the successful candidates in the Department of Economics, 2012

## CONFERENCES, SUMMER SCHOOLS AND TRAINING

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- Sheffield Workshop In Macroeconomics (SWIM), University of Sheffield, 2024
- 6th, 7th International Conference on Applied Theory, Macro and Empirical Finance, University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, *April 2022, April 2023*
- Macroeconomics Summer School, University of Surrey, *July 2022*
- Time Series Models for Macroeconomic Analysis, Macroeconometrics Summer School, Barcelona School of Economics, *June 2021*
- Bayesian Time Series Methods: DSGE Models Estimation, Macroeconometrics Summer School, Barcelona School of Economics, *July 2021*